

another. I take the Parsi parallel from Pahlavi books, the date of which of course makes borrowing from Christian Scriptures abundantly possible. Nevertheless, I greatly doubt whether this has really taken place: accidental coincidence seems to me far more likely. The Golden Rule in its negative form stands in a position by itself. I have put it into my conjectural restoration of the story underlying *Tobit* (p. 386), because it is found in Parsi writing and may be old: its appearance in *Tobit* may therefore be due to the very special conditions of that book. In the *Bundahish* (*SBE*, v.) we read several sentences to which Biblical parallels occur. Thus (p. 114) the darkness of hell is "fit to grasp with the hand": cf. *Exod.* 10²¹. Of the future life it is said (p. 126 f.):

They give every one his wife, and show him his children with his wife; so they act as now in the world, but there is no begetting of children.¹

There is a certain resemblance to *Luke* 20³⁵ f. A striking passage on p. 124 tells us that a righteous man who did not warn his wicked friend would suffer shame in the assembly of judgement: West quotes a parallel from *Ardâ-Vîraf*, where it is a husband who neglected to teach his wife. We may compare *Ezek.* 33¹⁻⁹.² A distant echo of *Matt.* 25⁴⁰ may be found in the *Dînkart* (*SBE*, xxxvii. 196), where we read:

¹ On this see Söderblom, *La Vie Future*, 269.

² I cannot see that there is any real resemblance between *2 Cor.* 5¹ and *Bd* 30² (*SBE*, v. 127): it is at most a similarity of phrase. It would be more to the point to illustrate Paul here by the Robe in the "Hymn of the Soul," noting that Bardaisan had Parsi affinities.